Black Pepper Soy Curls

with sticky rice

Delicious flavor with colorful veggies and its vegan! Super easy that has a delicious flavor. Soy curls are a great food staple for vegetarians and vegans because they are protein based and you can do so much with them. Spice it up or marinade them, bake them, pan fry them, shred them, crisp them.

Origin

Inspired by Sichuan pepper Chinese chicken. Szechuan chicken originates from the Sichuan province in southwestern China, a region historically renowned for its bold, spicy, and aromatic cuisine. It is characterized by the use of "mala" flavor—a combination of numbing Sichuan peppercorns and spicy chili peppers. Authentic versions often involve stir-frying crispy chicken with dried chilies and peppercorns.

At a Glance

- **Prep Time:** Estimated time, 15 minutes
- **Cook Time:** Estimated time, 35 minutes
- **Servings:** Number of servings, 6-8

Preparation – *Mis en place –Everything in its place*

Tasks to complete before the main cooking begins to ensure a smooth process.

- **Soak/Activate: soy curls** – 10 mins in water, then marinade in broth
- **Soak/ Activate**: rinse rice
- **Blanch broccoli –** put in boiling water for 4 mins, drain and then add to ice water
- **Chop/Dice:** peppers, onions, broccoli, garlic, ginger
- **Assemble:** All the sauces and spices
- **Assemble Tools:** knife, rice cooker, bowl of ice water for blanching, rice cooker

- **Primary Plant Protein/Base:**
- Soy Curls

- **Fresh Produce & Aromatics:**

- Onions – chopped medium
- Broccoli – small florets
- Red and green bell peppers– chopped medium
- Vegetable stock
- **Pantry Staples & Seasonings:**

FOR THE SOY CURLS

- Soy curls – 2 ½ cups
- Vegetable Broth – 2 cups
- Garlic powder – 2 tsp
- Ground pepper – 1 tsp
- Soy sauce – 4 tsp
- Rice Flour – Cover the soy curls about 1/4 cup

FOR THE SAUCE

- Soy sauce – 4 tbs
- Maple syrup – 2 tbs
- Oyster sauce – 3 tbs
- Crushed black pepper-1 tsp
- Mirin – 1 tbs
- Broth – 1cup (use vegetable stock – powder or homemade)
- Arrow root – 4 tsp
- Sticky rice – 2 cups

FOR THE VEGETABLES

- Sesame oil – 4 tsp
- Green and red pepper – 2 cups chopped
- Broccoli – ½ a bunch – cut medium and blanch
- Onion – 1 cup – ½ inch pieces
- Scallions – 1 package
- Garlic – 4 cloves minced
- Ginger – 1 inch minced

- **Garnishes/Toppings:** sesame seeds

🔪 Directions

Clear, sequential steps to guide the cooking process. Cook in "layers"

1. **Prepare**

RICE

1. Add 2 cups to rice cooker. Drain until water is no longer cloudy. Add enough water until the first line of your pointer finger

SOY CURLS

2. Soak the soy curls: Add the broth to a medium bowl and warm it in a microwave. Then add the soy curls and soak for 15 minutes
3. Once they are done soaking, drain the soy curls. (Reserve the soaking water) press the soy curls a little bit so that there is not too much excess moisture. Transfer the soy curls to a bowl.
4. In another small bowl create rice flour mixture - add the garlic powder, black pepper and rice flour, and mix in.
5. Add the soy sauce to the soy curls and toss well. Then add the rice flour mixture to coat. Pan fry on a skillet over medium heat with a heavy dose of Pam and 1 teaspoon of oil. Crisp each side for 3-4 mins.
6. Now add all the sauce/marinade ingredients to a bowl, mix well, and set aside.
7. Once the soy curls are crispy – move to a separate bowl.
8. Start the veggie sautéing process once the soy curls are done
9. Heat the large nonstick skillet over medium heat, add oil. Once the oil is hot, add in the onions and peppers first, once half cooked, and garlic and ginger and then broccoli. Add a pinch of salt and toss well. Cook for a minute or 2, we want the vegetables to be crunchy, but we also want the garlic to start to turn golden.
10. As soon as the garlic is starting to turn golden, add in the sauce mixture and mix in. Bring it to a boil and continue to cook for a minute for the sauce to thicken.
11. Once the sauce has thickened a little bit, add in the baked soy curls and toss well. Then take off heat.
12. Taste and adjust flavor. if you want it a little bit sweeter add in a little bit more maple syrup and mix in. You may also want to add more oyster sauce. If you want more heat, then add in more black pepper or red pepper flakes
13. Add to a small bowl of rice
14. Garnish with sesame seeds and peanuts—and serve with rice or cooked grains. Enjoy!

💡 Quick Tips

Bonus advice for variations, efficiency, and sustainability.

- **Flavor Boost:** the longer you marinate soy curls the tastier they will be.
- **Substitution:** Can add different vegetables – water chestnuts, bamboo shoots, carrots, green beans, Chinese eggplant to name a few! Can also substitute soy curls with seitan

Nutritional Information

Estimated values

Broccoli	35 Calories, 2.3 g Protein, 5.6-gram Carbs 2,2 G Fiber, .3 g Fat, Offers extensive health benefits, acting as a nutrient powerhouse rich in vitamins (C, K, A, folate), minerals, fiber, and antioxidants that support immunity, digestion, heart health, and brain function while potentially reducing inflammation and lowering the risk of certain cancers
Peppers	26-31 calories per 100 gms, 2-2.1grams of fiber, 1 gram of protein and very low fat Has nutrient-dense vegetables packed with vitamins (especially C, A, B6, K, E) and minerals (potassium, folate), providing antioxidants and fiber for digestive health.
Onions	38 Calories, 0.8 grams · Protein, 8.6 grams Carbs ·: 1.9 grams · Fiber Fat: 0.1 grams Significant health benefits due to their rich antioxidants (like quercetin) and prebiotic fibers, supporting gut health, heart health by lowering cholesterol and blood pressure,
Soy Curls	per 30 grams:120 Calories: Protein: 11 g. Sodium: 0 mg. very low in saturated fat, no cholesterol

What is a soy curl and are they good for you?

Yes! Soy Curls are made from non-GMO, whole soybeans without chemical pesticides, preservatives, or additives. They're also a great source of protein, fiber, iron, and potassium.

What's the difference between Soy curls and Tofu?

Tofu, while minimally processed, is not a whole food but provides high-quality protein, healthy fats, and often added calcium. Soy curls are closer to a whole food than highly processed soy products, as they retain fiber and protein from whole soybeans, but some nutrients are lost during processing.